# Structured Tables

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**Abstract**

A short comparison of MyST's two table syntaxes, with examples of captioned, labelled list tables.

Use the `{list-table}` directive when a table needs a caption, a label, or complex cell content.

## 1. Comparing the formats

| Feature | Pipe table | `{list-table}` |
|---|---|---|
| Caption | No | Yes |
| Cross-reference label | No | Yes |
| Multi-paragraph cells | No | Yes |
| Easy to read in source | Yes | Moderately |

Table 1: Comparison of MyST table syntaxes

As Table 1 shows, list tables cost a little readability in the source and give you much more flexibility in return.

**Important**

Every row of a `{list-table}` must have the same number of items. A missing cell causes a build error rather than an empty cell.

## 2. Formulas in tables

| Shape | Area |
|---|---|
| Circle | $\pi r^2$ |
| Annulus | $\pi(r_2^2 - r_1^2)$ |
| Triangle | $\frac{1}{2}bh$ |

Table 2: Areas of common shapes

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